



Working together

*to enhance safety, reduce congestion and maximize economic development
along the U.S. Highway 169 interregional corridor.*

U.S. HIGHWAY 169 CORRIDOR COALITION

Work Plan

MISSION STATEMENT:

Working together to enhance safety, reduce congestion and maximize economic development along the U.S. Highway 169 inter-regional corridor.

2008 Work Tasks Initiated:

1) Organization and Administration:

- a) Organize and begin regular meetings of the Steering Committee, Policy Committee, and Technical Committee.
- b) Establish regular meeting schedules for the above-named committees, and a quarterly meeting schedule for the Coalition once formed.
- c) Establish regular processes for administrative tasks such as keeping minutes and financial records.
- d) Develop a joint powers agreement (JPA) for the establishment of the Coalition that will be adopted by the Steering Committee by the end of 2008.
- e) Develop a “seed” capital funding plan for 2009 activities; have the funding plan adopted by the Steering Committee; and begin to secure funding commitments for 2009 from cities and counties in the Corridor.

2) Project Funding

- a) Prepare a letter for Coalition submittal (approve at Jan. 22, 2009 General Meeting) to Federal Delegation and DOT Commissioner regarding stimulus package including:
 - i) US 169/I494
 - ii) US 169 and Lind/Webster Interchange
 - iii) Le Sueur Over pass
 - iv) Members to add any other “ready to go” projects

2009 Work Plan:

1) *Project Funding:*

- a) Secure a Federal Transportation Reauthorization Bill (FTRB) appropriation in the range of about \$1.5 million to \$5 million for studies throughout the corridor, right-of-way acquisition and possible projects.
 - i) Prepare applications to Congressional and Senate representatives for the designation of TH 169 in the FTRB. Key Congressional partners include Representative Walz, Rep. Oberstar, Rep. Kline, Senator Elect (?) and Senator Klobuchar.
 - ii) If the appropriation is secured, it can also be used to defray the ongoing cost of engineering and publication work related to the Corridor and Coalition.
- b) Prioritize identified projects in the Corridor for funding, paying particular attention to geographic balance in project investment.
- c) As a part of the project identification and prioritization processes, insure that transit mode and alignment of transit, as well as possible project investments, in the TH 169 Corridor is identified
- d) Assist local agencies with materials and message delivery for use in their activities in Washington, D.C. and at the state legislature.

2) *Organization and Administration:*

- a) Develop a budget for 2009.
- b) Organize and begin regular meetings of the Steering Committee, Policy Committee, and Technical Committee.
- c) Establish regular meeting schedules for the above-named committees, and a quarterly meeting schedule for the Coalition once formed.
- d) Establish regular processes for administrative tasks such as keeping minutes and financial records.
- e) Adopt a joint powers agreement (JPA) for the establishment of the Coalition that was recommended by the Steering Committee by the end of 2008.
- f) Develop a “seed” capital funding plan for 2009 activities; have the funding plan adopted by the Steering Committee; and begin to secure funding commitments of at least \$60,000.00 for 2009 from cities and counties in the Corridor.

3) *Coalition Building:*

- a) Develop a request for qualifications (RFQ) through the Technical Advisory Committee for the services of a “corridor advocate” who would;
 - i) Recruit additional governmental agencies for membership in the Coalition;
 - ii) Raise interest in the business community in the Corridor, the Coalition and the work of the Coalition.
- b) Interview and select a “corridor advocate.”
- c) Develop and put in place published materials and communications that will assist the “corridor advocate” and the Coalition in building interest in the Corridor, the Coalition and its activities. These would include, but would not be limited to;
 - i) Establishment, production and distribution of a print and/or electronic Corridor newsletter;
 - ii) Design, establishment and update of a Corridor website.

2010 and Beyond:

1) *Project Funding:*

- a) Identify and secure additional Federal and State funding for future studies throughout the corridor, right-of-way acquisition and additional projects.
- b) Assist local agencies with materials and message delivery for use in their activities in Washington, D.C. and at the state legislature.

2) *Organization and Administration:*

- a) Hold regular meetings of the Coalition board, the Steering Committee, Policy Committee, and Technical Advisory Committee.
- b) Establish the annual Coalition budget and membership fee schedule.
- c) Maintain Coalition administrative and financial records.

3) *Coalition Building:*

- a) Recruit additional governmental agencies for membership in the Coalition;
- b) Raise and maintain interest in the business community in the Corridor, the Coalition and the work of the Coalition.
 - i) Maintain and, as needed, develop new published materials and communications that will assist the “corridor advocate” and the Coalition in building interest in the Corridor, the Coalition and its activities.

4) *Consultants:* Retain consultants as necessary to build and advance the interests of the Coalition